

2.2 Discursive and persuasive writing

Paper 2 Writing · 2026 examination · Concept guide and original exam-style practice

Understand the concept

Discursive writing weighs viewpoints and qualifies claims; persuasive writing aims to move a specific audience through selection, sequencing and rhetorical appeals. Distinguish evidence from assertion; use concession before rebuttal rather than a straw opponent. A clear introduction frames the issue, and a conclusion follows the argument.

Worked example: follow the reasoning

For a speech on later school start times, admit transport costs, then argue for a small pilot with measurable attendance outcomes; this is more credible than claiming universal benefits without evidence.

Original practice stimulus

Writing brief: Student representatives are debating whether the school day should begin later. Some students travel more than an hour to school; others help with younger siblings in the afternoon. The administration can run a six-week trial but cannot change public bus timetables immediately. You are speaking at the representatives' meeting. Argue for or against a later start. Recognise one practical objection fairly, explain what evidence a trial could collect, and end with a realistic request to the representatives. The audience is familiar with school routines but has not made a decision.

Extended response

Compose your response in the space provided and support your interpretation with evidence.

1 Write a 180–220 word speech paragraph to student representatives arguing for or against a later school start. Include one concession and one concrete proposal. [25]

Check: relevant evidence · coherent argument · accurate and deliberate language

Answers and explanation

Question 1 [25 marks]

A strong paragraph identifies student audience, gives an arguable claim, anticipates the transport objection, proposes a timed trial and avoids fabricated research. Reward sustained voice, coherent transitions and a persuasive close; language is assessed in its rhetorical context.

Self-assessment

Compare each credited step with your own answer. Fix the first reasoning or calculation error; then retry without looking at the solution.

Syllabus: English Language 9093, 2024–2026.

<https://www.cambridgeinternational.org/Images/635901-2024-2026-syllabus.pdf>

Original FagusED teaching material. Question layout and mark presentation informed by the May/June 2026 papers supplied by the user. The practice question is newly written and is not a Cambridge past-paper question.